

Nilgoun Bahar, PhD, SLP

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EDUCATION

- University of Oxford** Oxford, UK
PhD, Experimental Psychology Jan 2025
- Dissertation: Neuropsychological and Neuroimaging Investigations of Developmental Language Disorder in Children and Adolescents
- University of Toronto** Toronto, ON,
MHSc, Speech-Language Pathology; Minor in Audiology Sep 2021
- Clinical training in evidence-based assessment and intervention for speech, language, communication, and swallowing disorders across the lifespan.
- University of British Columbia** Vancouver, BC,
BA (Hons), Film Studies; Minor in Spanish Jul 2018
- Honours thesis: Prosody and Poetic Language as Catalysts to Personal Transformation in Movies of Terrence Malick

PUBLICATIONS & PREPRINTS

- Bahar, N.**, Arabadzhyska, D., Jones, H., Singh, S., Davis, M., Ricketts, J., Ripollés, P., & Krishnan, S. (2026). Striatal activity during contextual word learning is influenced by children's reading ability. *bioRxiv* [Preprint]. <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.07.06.736136>
- Bahar, N.**, Cler, G. J., Asaridou, S. S., Smith, H. J., Willis, H. E., Healy, M. P., Chughtai, S., Haile, M., Krishnan, S., & Watkins, K. E. (2026). Neural correlates of novel word-form learning in developmental language disorder. *bioRxiv* [Preprint]. <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.03.28.715039>
- Pinheiro-Chagas, P., Kersey, M., **Bahar, N.**, Inkelis, S., Mauer, E., Siebert, J., Vonk, J., Bogley, R., Carpenter, E., Martin-Moreno, D. V., De Leon, J., Tee, B. L., Mandelli, M. L., Pereira, C., Miller, Z., & Gorno-Tempini, M. L. (2026). Data-driven cognitive clusters in persistent developmental dyslexia. *Cortex*, 204, 216–228. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cortex.2026.08.006>
- Palser, E. R., **Bahar, N.**, Carpenter, E., Bardorf, M., Kersey, M., Bogley, R., Inkelis, S., Pinheiro-Chagas, P., Tee, B.-L., DeLeon, J., Sturm, V. E., Miller, Z. A., Mandelli, M. L., Gorno Tempini, M. L., & Pereira, C. (2026). Spoken language delay in toddlerhood predicts late childhood language outcomes in dyslexia: Evidence from retrospective parent-report. *Annals of Dyslexia*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11881-026-00387-w>
- Cler, G. J., Asaridou, S. S., **Bahar, N.**, Krishnan, S., Smith, H. J., Willis, H. E., Healy, M. P., & Watkins, K. E. (2026). Subcortical correlates of developmental language disorder: More than the neostriatum. *Brain Communications*, 8(1), fcaf493. <https://doi.org/10.1093/braincomms/fcaf493>
- Namasivayam, A. K., Kent, R., Preston, J. L., Maassen, B. A. M., Hagedorn, C., Nip, I. S. B., McAllister, A., Wang, J., Hustad, K., Ménard, L., **Bahar, N.**, Moore, J. G., Petrosov, J., & van Lieshout, P. (2025). Reevaluating the classification of pediatric speech sound disorders: A ground truthing perspective. *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*, 19, 1700505.
- Bahar, N.**, Cler, G. J., Krishnan, S., Asaridou, S. S., Smith, H. J., Willis, H. E., Healy, M. P., & Watkins, K. E. (2024). Differences in cortical surface area in developmental language disorder. *Neurobiology of Language*, 5(2), 288–314. https://doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00127
- Bahar, N.**, Namasivayam, A. K., & van Lieshout, P. (2022). Telehealth intervention and childhood apraxia of speech: A scoping review. *Speech, Language and Hearing*, 25(4), 450–462. <https://doi.org/10.1080/2050571X.2021.1947649>

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

- UCSF Dyslexia Center and Language Neurobiology Lab** San Francisco, CA
Postdoctoral and clinical fellow, University of California, San Francisco Apr 2025–Present
- Brain, Speech, and Language Group** Oxford, UK
PhD Candidate, University of Oxford Oct 2021–Nov 2024
- Neuroscience of Communication Development Group** Egham, UK
Research Associate, Royal Holloway, University of London Mar 2022–Apr 2024

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Bahar, N.** (2026, October). Longitudinal changes in caudate nucleus myelination in developmental language disorder [Poster presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Geneva, Switzerland.
- Bahar, N.** (2026, September). Neuroanatomical differences across different cognitive profiles in developmental dyslexia [Poster presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Geneva, Switzerland.
- Bahar, N.** (2025, September). Developmental dyslexia and attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder in children: Cognitive and neuroanatomical mechanisms of co-occurrence [Poster presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Washington, DC, USA.
- Bahar, N.** (2025, September). Longitudinal changes in cortical grey matter in adolescents with developmental language disorder [Poster presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Washington, DC, USA.
- Bahar, N.** (2024, June). An investigation of reward processing during word learning in neurotypical and dyslexic children [Symposium presentation]. British Dyslexia Association, Surrey, England.
- Bahar, N.** (2023, October). Neural activity associated with novel word form learning in developmental language disorder [Poster presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Marseille, France.
- Bahar, N.** (2023, June). Finding the joy: Investigating reward-processing during word learning in children with and without dyslexia [Poster presentation]. Neurodevelopmental Annual Seminar, Egham, Surrey, UK.
- Bahar, N.** (2022, October). Differences in cortical surface area in developmental language disorder [Poster and oral presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Philadelphia, PA, USA.
- Bahar, N., & Namasivayam, A. K.** (2021, July). Telehealth intervention and childhood apraxia of speech: A scoping review [Oral presentation]. Apraxia Kids National Conference, Plano, TX, USA.
- Bahar, N., & Namasivayam, A. K.** (2021, July). Objective methods to assess progress in the ReST treatment program for CAS: A case study [Poster presentation]. Apraxia Kids National Conference, Plano, TX, USA.

AWARDS & GRANTS

Neurobiology of Language - Editor-in-Chief Best Paper, Honourable Mention	Sep 2025
Nancy Lurie Marks Family Foundation - Genetics & Neurobiology of Language CSHL Grant	May 2024
Wolfson College Grant	Oct 2023
Guarantors of Brain Grant	Oct 2022
Society for the Neurobiology of Language Travel Grant	Jul 2022
Letter of Distinction in Interprofessional Education	Apr 2022
Award of Excellence in Developmental Speech & Language Disorders	Dec 2020
The Speech Foundation of Ontario Child Language Prize	Dec 2020
Harmonize for Speech Excellence Award	Nov 2020
Chris Gandy International Outreach Award (India)	Nov 2019
Barbara Meissner-Fishbein Memorial Award	Sep 2019

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

The Hospital for Sick Children (SickKids)	Toronto, ON
<i>SLP Student Clinician</i>	Jan–Aug 2021
Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams and families in neonatal, psychiatry, and brain tumor services to assess communication needs, establish therapy goals, deliver intervention.	
Amar Seva Sangam	Tamil Nadu, India
<i>SLP Student Clinician</i>	May–Aug 2021
Delivered teletherapy, collaborated with local stakeholders to support development of a community speech-therapy center, developed clinical guidance for telepractice.	
Speech Avenue Speech Language Services	Toronto, ON
<i>SLP Student Clinician</i>	May–Aug 2021
Assessed communication needs of autistic children, delivered play-based intervention, wrote school reports.	
Aphasia Institute – Pat Arato Centre	Toronto, ON
<i>SLP Student Clinician</i>	Nov–Dec 2021
Applied Supported Conversation for Adults with Aphasia (SCA™) principles to reduce communication barriers for adults with aphasia.	
Integrated Services for Autism & Neurodevelopmental Disorders	Toronto, ON
<i>Clinical Placement</i>	Mar 2021
Collaborated with an interdisciplinary healthcare team supporting children with complex care needs.	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

fMRI: Experimental Design & Analysis	Jan–Feb 2024
<i>Teaching Assistant, University of Oxford</i>	

Cognition Core Practicals <i>Teaching Assistant, University of Oxford</i>	Feb 2023; Feb 2024
Neurobiology of Speech & Language <i>Tutor, University of Oxford</i>	Apr–Jun 2023
Developmental Science <i>Tutor, University of Oxford</i>	Apr–Jun 2023
Introductory Psychology (intensive one-month course) <i>Instructor, University of Oxford</i>	Jul 2022
Psychology of Language <i>Tutor, University of Oxford</i>	Oct–Dec 2022
Introduction to Cognitive Psychology <i>Tutor, University of Oxford</i>	Oct–Dec 2022

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Oral Dynamics Lab <i>Research Assistant, University of Toronto</i>	Toronto, ON Mar 2020–Feb 2023
Brain & Language Sciences Lab <i>Research Assistant, University of Toronto</i>	Toronto, ON Apr 2020–May 2021
Child Language & Cognition Lab <i>Research Assistant, University of British Columbia</i>	Vancouver, BC Mar 2017–Apr 2019

TECHNICAL & LANGUAGE SKILLS

Neuroimaging: Functional, structural, quantitative MRI processing and analysis: FSL; FreeSurfer; VBM, VBA
Programming / experimental tools: R; MATLAB; Python; PsychoPy; shell
Languages: English and Farsi (fluent); Spanish and French (advanced)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Society for the Neurobiology of Language	Sep 2022–Present
The College of Speech & Hearing Health Professionals of British Columbia	Sep 2021–Present
Oxford Character Project	Apr 2023–Present
British Neuroscience Association	Sep 2022–Present